

SEASON 01 EPISODE 06

Band Practice

1 INT. ELECTIONS - DAY

1

ADELINE, a secretarybird, BULLOCK, an ox, and GURNICK, a dog, sit by three respective podiums.

With crowds cheering and bands playing a rock tune, the debates go by in the blink of an eye.

BULLOCK

-With the Mammalian Mainland in long-term turmoil, we need better industry! We need better infrastructure!

ADELINE

-But my reforms don't end with the budget, I will ensure that every last person in that building remains checked!

GURNICK

-Green doesn't mean submission, it means power! It means sustenance! Life!

The faces of the three candidates echo like shocks in caves running at each other.

Imagery: Repiles, avians, mammals, tossing everyone out of the country.

2 EXT. CHURCH - DAY

2

DONG! DONG! DONG!

JUNIPER- a dog- stands with his two older siblings, JOHN and LAUREL- and his parents JANE and SEYMOUR-

Before a red-brick suburban cathedral.

They head inside.

They're some of the last ones in.

The gate closes. The priest delivers the sermon. His voice ECHOES through the halls inside:

PRIEST (V.O.)

Many of you have heard of the protests downtown. Whoever you are, do not lose faith, and do not keep praying for your fellow animals to find their way.

Upturned signs on the ground, in front of the gates.

PRIEST (V.O.)
 They say the Lord was a fallen
 soldier from a land not so removed
 of our own.

More signs.

PRIEST (V.O.)
 That he arose from the ashes of
 another world, of another universe,
 to grant us salvation and identity.

Trash and easy cleaning.

PRIEST (V.O.)
 Why did the Lord place us all on an
 archipelago where almost no two
 people were alike?

A janitor sweeps the mess.

PRIEST (V.O.)
 Because He wanted to test us. To
 test our diversity against the odds
 of 10,000 years.

He brings out his phone.

PRIEST (V.O.)
 And after 10,000 years, the world
 shall be born again.

And resumes his music.

3 EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY

3

Large and small animals of WESTSIDE hold signs supporting
 Adeline.

Medium animals of EASTSIDE hold signs supporting Bullock.

They yell in protest. The police run in the way.

They face the large and small with shields of their own.

In the distance, a young brown bear- HAZEL- crosses with
 her hoodie on.

LARGE ANIMAL
 Bring back our salaries!

SMALL ANIMAL
 Where's our 1%?!

WESTSIDE
 1%! 1%!

4 EXT. OUTSKIRTS - DAY

4

Hazel crosses behind them. Behind: SIENNA, KODY- black and kermode bears, respectively.

They push past foliage, into a sewer.

KODY
"I know a spot." Shit is filthy
bruh.

No response.

KODY
No one gonna talk to me? Hello?

They emerge. Out is more foliage.

KODY
(mumbles)
Swear to god...

They push out into an open view of the outskirts.

At a clifftop. Hilly, serene.

SIENNA
Can't you do something? Find a bug
or some shit!

KODY
Who, me?

SIENNA
Yeah, you!

KODY
Fine.
(hesitates)
Fine.

Kody disappears behind bushes.

Sienna sits down with Hazel, thigh to thigh. He brings out a joint. Lights it.

Hazel shivers, rubs her hands together excitedly. Kody hits. Passes it to Hazel. Hazel hits.

SIENNA
Man, fuck all that. Just tryna smoke
and the entire town's on our asses?

HAZEL
I don't give a shit. Babe, why you
still inviting Kody?

SIENNA
'Cause he says he's lonely or
whatever.

HAZEL
He can be lonely at home.

Sienna blows out. Changes subject.

SIENNA
How's your mom?

Hazel waits.

HAZEL
Tiring.

Hazel blows.

HAZEL
She thinks immigration customs is
gonna bust our asses.

SIENNA
Oh yeah, huh?
(takes a long drag)
They're not coming here. Trust.

HAZEL
I told her that, but her bitchass
won't listen.
(takes a long drag)
She never fucking listens.

Hazel begins shaking. Her arms wrap around her body.

SIENNA
Here.

Sienna tries to hold her, to rock her.

HAZEL
No.

SIENNA
Here!

HAZEL
No!

SIENNA
Here!

HAZEL
Stop- stop!

Sienna takes his hands off.

SIENNA
Just giving you something to hold
onto. Prick.

The two stare into the sky.

Kody, around the corner, listens. He gets up and just
leaves. Disappears back into the bustling town.

5 INT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - DAY

5

FRANK, a fat fox with biker gloves and a vest- watches the
televised protests on the news.

He switches the channel.

REPORTER
Adeline's up three points, Bullock's
up six-

Switches.

REPORTER
Gurnick claims he'll be touring the
countryside after the election
season is over-

He taps, taps, but the remote breaks.

FRANK
(frustrated)
Ah, come on!

Frank rummages for batteries. His son- FERGIE- gets out of
the bedroom, SLAMS the door to the garage. The garage door
opens.

FRANK
Ferg! Ferg!

Frank opens the door, runs outside.

FRANK
Ferg, you better not be playin' at 9
in the morning!

Fergie, guitar in hand, yells back.

FERGIE
You said to play at 9 'cause power's
doubled at 3!

FRANK
(points to downtown)
You hear that?!

FERGIE
They're not gonna reach us! I'll
close the garage!

FRANK
Fuck you then.

FERGIE
Fuck you!

Door SLAMS. A ferret appears at the driveway. Fergie's
friend- DAX.

DAX
He good?!

Dax on drums while Fergie plays guitar.

FERGIE
He's out of his mind. It's not gonna
reach us.

The two boys play and riff off of each other. They hit a
nice tune- then stop.

Distant yelling in the background.

DAX
Is it really safe, though?

FERGIE
Just waiting on Quisha and Harley.

QUISHA, a porcupine, appears on the driveway, along with a
rabbit. HARLEY.

FERGIE
Speak of the devil. Hey! Let's close
it!

The garage closes. The band commits to song.

Fergie on electric guitar. Dax on drums. Quisha on
keyboard. Harley on mic.

HARLEY
If I could... I'd put your stars in
my casket...

Dax squints. He doesn't like it.

HARLEY
And fly!

The mic gets FEEEDBACK.

FERGIE
Pause! Timeout!

Fergie goes up to Harley.

FERGIE
We're gonna need to cut "fly" out of
the lyrics.

HARLEY
What else do I sing?

FERGIE
Run? Gallop!

DAX
Gallop is what horses do.

QUISHA
Can we just play, bitches?

The group argues, louder and louder, until Harley YELLS.

HARLEY
You know what?

The group stops.

HARLEY
I'm not gonna argue with you
anymore. You can write your own
lyrics.
(mic drop)
I'm done.

FERGIE
No, no, no wait wait wait-

The mic hits the floor. FEEDBACK!

Fergie shuts off the radio. Harley goes to the door, but-

FERGIE
Hold on. Let me get that for you.

Fergie touches the garage opener.

Harley steps out into the open world. The yells are
louder.

HARLEY
Great. Just great.

Harley heads eastside. The garage closes.

The group sighs in quiet.

QUISHA
 If you guys don't get a singer in
 the next week, I quit.

6 EXT. CLASSROOM - DAY

6

Among a midst of dozens of homecoming posters, with red hearts-

And election campaign posters, colored in blue-

Fergie POSTS AN OPENING for a singer, with tearable slips on the bottom.

The bulletin board is filled to the max. A cat, a rat, and the familiar paw of a rabbit- rips out a slot.

7 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

7

The students sit in class.

TEACHER
 The avian caste is divided into
 three levels. We have high nobility,
 low...

The board shines with gold and yellow as birds of paradise appear on the screen.

TEACHER
 The lower caste, dubbed Paradise,
 designates concubines, male and
 female, regardless of gender, to
 serve the higher ups in what we call
 involuntary servitude. A.K.A.
 slavery, A.K.A... no, that's- yeah,
 that's just slavery.

EVE, a rabbit, listens intently. She keeps her arms crossed. She already knows this.

TEACHER
 Whereas birds of Prey remain on the
 top. This is the caste that avian
 candidates- listen class- avian
 candidates that Adeline- belong to.

A student- a DOG- mutters under his breath.

STUDENT
 (mutters)
 Hypocrites...

TEACHER
 What was that, dear?

STUDENT

Nothing.

The rabbit in front of Eve whirls around.

HARLEY

Why aren't you writing?

8 INT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - DAY

8

Same girl. Harley was the singer.

9 INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

9

Eve ignores her like a diva.

So Harley spins around, not before noticing a slip on Eve's hand.

She grunts.

TEACHER

The middle, we'll save for later.

THE BELL RINGS.

10 INT. CAFETERIA - DAY

10

Eve sits at a table with Louis and Juniper, as well as her friends, PETUNIA and ROSALINE.

She stares at her slip, twirling it.

PETUNIA

You totally should join a band! Are you kidding?

EVE

(rolls eyes)

But what if they don't take me because I listen to Adeline?

ROSALINE

If a band actually cares about your growth, they won't kick you out over some artist you listen to.

EVE

But they will consider me over her.

JUNIPER

Petunia, be realistic. She's right.

ROSALINE

Don't mansplain.

JUNIPER

I'm not-
 (crosses arms)
 Ugh.

ROSALINE

Love you.

LOUIS

All valid points, y'all. But here's
 the bigger question. Where is this
 exactly?

EVE

9600 Eslaine Avenue.

Rosaline brings out her phone. It's a one-story home on
 the tracks.

ROSALINE

Should we come with you or...?

EVE

Honestly, if I get kidnapped, I get
 kidnapped.

Eve laughs it off- but she bites her lip.

LOUIS

I'll come with. We both live across
 the tracks.

Rosaline and Petunia look to Eve for confirmation.

EVE

(reluctant)
 Okay. Sure.

A fight breaks out between two large animals in the
 cafeteria. The group continues eating.

CROWD

Fight! Fight! Fight!

11 EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY

11

Louis and Eve walk along the tracks, quiet- but never
 crossing it. Ignoring signs on the ground, batons, stains
 from mace.

They look across the tracks, into WESTSIDE.

EVE

So how'd you figure out I live here?

LOUIS

Because I live here.

EVE
 (raises eyebrows)
 That actually makes a lot of sense.

LOUIS
 My mom works at a salon. My dad
 works at a tailor shop. Downtown.
 Both downtown.

EVE
 So you cross- so you come back and
 forth often?

LOUIS
 Yeah, I cross the railroad. It's
 illegal, but...
 (glances at the ground)
 Anyway, I memorized most of the
 neighborhood, the routes.
 (sighs)
 As you should.

EVE
 (smiles)
 Oh shit. As if Juniper would know.

LOUIS
 He actually used to live across me.

EVE
 Really?

LOUIS
 What, you think a bear from westside
 and a dog from eastside magically
 get along from day one?

EVE
 Still. As if he would know.

Louis chuckles. She's right.

EVE
 But I didn't know that.

12 EXT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - DAY

12

Not a single singer- male or female- is there.
 Just Fergie and the band.

LOUIS
 Should I...

Eve debates, but pauses.

EVE
Wait here for 10 minutes. If you see
something batshit crazy, call the
cops.

Louis nods.

LOUIS
Don't die.

Eve walks up to the group.

FERGIE
(whispering to Dax)
Fucking god, another rabbit showed
up?

DAX
Is she the only one?

Quisha squints at them.

FERGIE
Hey! Fergie.

EVE
Eve.

FERGIE
We're looking for a singer. What've
you got?

Eve pauses, then pulls out a sheet note.

EVE
Just- can you guys read this?

The other three huddle together.

Fergie raises an eyebrow.

FERGIE
I can read this. You can.

EVE
Well, duh.

Fergie looks at the others.

FERGIE
Hit it.

The other three hit it. Eve begins singing.

EVE
I'll flock to the cities-

Quisha's eyes widen. Fergie's, Dax's. They're impressed.
They keep playing.

EVE
And I'll be part of the world that
keeps running-

Quisha on piano.

EVE
That never sleeps...

Dax on drums.

EVE
That never eats...

Fergie on guitar.

EVE
Till its hunger feeds the world.

Fergie nods. He huddles with the group.

QUISHA
She's great.

DAX
She's awesome.

FERGIE
So we in agreement? Well we can't
look desparate. What do we tell her?

Dax's eyes widen.

DAX
Hold on.

Dax searches on social media: ADELINE 2007 PERFORMANCE.

Fergie's eyes widen.

FERGIE
Fuckin' knew it.

QUISHA
You guys kidding me? This is what
you'll reject her over?

FERGIE
I just wanna know why, where she
comes from, okay?

The group turns around. But just before Fergie shows Eve
the phone-

Frank bursts into the garage.

FRANK
Hey! Is that Adeline?!

Eve, shocked- raises her eyebrows. She nods. Takes a step back.

Louis, about to turn the corner, stops.

FRANK
I used to listen to that woman's
music from before she became a
politican! Say, what do you know?

FERGIE
Dad, just-

FRANK
I'm not embarrassin' anyone kid.

Frank steps out. He holds out his hand.

FRANK
Frank. Fergie's dad.

Eve, terrified- glances at Quisha and the others.

Quisha glances back at her. She'd never been in this scenario.

Eve takes Frank's hand and shakes it.

The wind blows. Frank glances around. Everone looks tense, uncomfortable.

FRANK
Well, I'll leave you all to it then.
Have a good one.

The door closes. Frank fits his big body inside.

Eve blinks twice. She clears her throat.

EVE
Hey, uh- so-

FERGIE
Yeah, yeah, yeah! Sorry.

Fergie sighs.

FERGIE
Listen. We want you.

Eve takes a step back.

EVE
 Sorry, that was just a little
 off-putting, you know?

Fergie takes a step forward.

FERGIE
 It's my dad, he's like that, it's...

Eve takes a step back, but stands her ground. She's shaking.

Louis walks up to the group. He holds out his phone.

FERGIE
 What, this your bodyguard or something?

EVE
 No, I just-

Eve freezes up.

LOUIS
 Eve, you good? Everything okay?

Eve runs, backs out of the driveway.

LOUIS
 Eve!

Louis chases after her.

Eve runs through westside.

LOUIS
 Eve, Fucking Christ, just hold on!

Eve trips over a sign. She turns the corner and LEAPS toward the train tracks. Crosses them.

13 EXT. EVE'S HOUSE - DAY

13

Eve reaches her house. She fumbles with her keys.

LOUIS
 Eve- fuck-

Louis comes panting onto the ground.

LOUIS
 Just hold on.

Eve pauses. She turns around, looks everywhere.

Shit. This is it. This is her only home. And she just gave it away in broad daylight.

LOUIS
Eve- god...

Louis backs away, stays at the gate.

LOUIS
Listen- you- talk to me.

EVE
I don't know, I just... I can't. Not
with everything going on in the news
and-

LOUIS
Nah, I get that, but this is your
shot! They like you!

EVE
His *dad* likes me!

LOUIS
No one means it like that! He was
just saying hi!

Eve turns around, fumbles with the keys.

LOUIS
Listen, Eve, I know because I'm a
huge animal, and I have to be
friendly all the time.

Eve stops. She whirls around.

EVE
What does that mean?

LOUIS
It means if I force a smile, it's
not because I'm trying to seduce
you, it's because I had a shitty day
and don't wanna come off like an
asshole.

Eve glances down at the floorboards of her house. Louis
takes it in.

Eve hugs her knees on the porch.

Louis goes in through the gate. He sits down.

EVE
Okay.

Louis's eyes dart.

LOUIS
Okay?
(nods)
Come on.

14 EXT. TRAIN TRACKS - DAY

14

The group crosses back.

15 EXT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - DAY

15

Louis arrives with Eve.

The group is packing.

EVE
Hey!

Fergie wraps his guitar.

FERGIE
(sad)
Huh? Oh yeah. It's you.

DAX
We decided to disband. No hard
feelings.

EVE
Hold on just one second.
(gulps)
Play a tune you guys like, and I'll
find lyrics for it.

Fergie, Dax and Quisha glance at each other.

QUISHA
You heard her.

Fergie brings out his guitar and plays. Dax unwraps his
drumsticks. Quisha takes out the piano.

The group plays. Eve gives Louis a thumbs-up.

Louis turns around and heads back.

He takes out his phone. On it, instead of 911, he dials:
JUNIPER.

RING RING! RING RING!

JUNIPER (O.S.)
How'd it go?

LOUIS
You can come over if you want.

JUNIPER (O.S.)

Yeah?

LOUIS

Yeah! I asked Mom and Dad this time.

Louis turns the corner and steals it.

16 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY

16

Louis enters his house.

BELINDA, his mother, is in the kitchen.

HENRY, his father, is in the dining room.

BELINDA

We're setting up for the party this weekend. You said you'd help.

LOUIS

(smacks lips)

I asked to have June over. Can we do this tomorrow?

Belinda sighs. She brings out her phone.

BELINDA

Hazel! Get back here, now!

Louis closes the door to his bedroom. Juniper arrives on the porch.

Inside Louis's house, they draw and work on studies.

A clean tune comes by.

LOUIS

June?

JUNIPER

Yeah?

LOUIS

You okay with all the yelling?

JUNIPER

Why wouldn't I be?

LOUIS

'Cause we're loud and annoying.

JUNIPER

I don't think you're either of those things.

LOUIS
And my family?

JUNIPER
They seem fine to me.

Louis glances out into the open world. Hazel unlocks the door.

Hazel and Belinda begin yelling like it's nobody's business.

Louis glances down at his paper. He tosses June headphones.

June stares at them- but tosses them aside.

LOUIS
June?

JUNIPER
Yeah?

LOUIS
If I was bigger and fatter, would you think I'm a weirdo?

JUNIPER
No.

LOUIS
Do you think Eve would think I'm a weirdo?

JUNIPER
No.

LOUIS
Petunia? Rosaline?

JUNIPER
No. I mean, we're just kids.

Louis nods and glances at his paper. He turns it.

The yelling gets louder and louder. Juniper flinches. Louis's breathing grows shaky.

Juniper breaks the silence.

JUNIPER
Mom didn't like the sermon this Sunday. She said it was too woke.

Louis laughs. Juniper chuckles.

Louis stops writing. He goes up to Juniper and pats him on the head.

LOUIS
I'm gonna go out there.

JUNIPER
Good luck, soldier.

Louis opens the door, then closes it.

Juniper's smile drops. He grabs the headphones and places them on. As the yelling and laughter fades away:

The wind whirls in Louis's room.

17 INT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - DAY 17

Fergie's dad watches the elections on the news. He pets Fergie.

Fergie half-smiles, heads to bed.

18 INT. EVE'S HOUSE - DAY 18

Eve returns home. She tells her sister, ERNIE, about her day, yelling to her. Ernie listens and crosses her fingers on the table.

She laughs so hard, she coughs. They hug.

Ernie leads Eve to the TV, and for the first time, they watch the elections.

Adeline appears onscreen. Not just in her house-

19 INT. VARIOUS HOUSES - DAY 19

But in all the houses of the city.

20 EXT. DOWNTOWN - DAY 20

LOUIS (V.O.)
Months after the debates started,
the first mock tally vote started.

Downtown is quiet.

Fergie's dad walks up to a booth. He places an X for Adeline.

Louis's mother, Belinda, X's Adeline.

Juniper's parents mark Xs.

Dogs and bears stare at each other, tense.

LOUIS (V.O.)
And it was then that whatever peace
we had as a town-

Protestors outside the booths. Belinda holds onto her
pepper spray.

LOUIS (V.O.)
Whatever friendships we last made
before then-

21 EXT. FERGIE'S HOUSE - DAY 21

Fergie and the group nod. The garage closes.

LOUIS
Would be the friendships we'd have
to stick with for a long time.

22 INT. LOUIS'S HOUSE - DAY 22

Juniper works on his notes, headphones on.

CUT TO:

23 EXT. TALENS - NIGHT 23

The city sleeps that night. The air is so quiet you could
hear wind.

For a moment, it looks post-apocalyptic-

Before the real war begins.

CUT TO BLACK.